

WITH SUBSTANCE

► **SPECS:** GOOGLE TENSOR G4;
6.3-INCH OLED 1080X2424p AT 422
PPI; 12GB RAM, 256GB STORAGE;
CAMERAS: 50MP WIDE, 48MP
ULTRAWIDE, 10.5 MP DUAL PD
SELFIE; 4,700 mAh

REVIEW

Year after year, Google has added minor updates to its Pixel phones—a slightly faster fingerprint sensor here, some uniform bezels there—that don't necessarily make headlines but eventually create a device that feels just right. And that device is the Pixel 9.

From the front, the Pixel 9 resembles an iPhone. The 6.3-inch screen is a touch larger than its predecessor, the Pixel 8. And while its resolution is just 1080p, it's sharp enough to provide a satisfying viewing experience. The Pixel 9 shares its main and ultrawide cameras with the Pro models but lacks a telephoto lens, though Google's lossless 2x crop zoom is adequate for most scenarios.

Battery life and screen brightness are on par with the rest of the Pixel 9 series. Even under moderate to heavy use, the battery easily lasts all day,



and the screen remains usable even in bright sunlight. The Pixel 9 is powered by Google's latest Tensor G4 that handles daily tasks with ease and doesn't heat up as much as its predecessor.

While the software remains as clean and intuitive as ever, the Pixel 9 skips some of the AI-powered features reserved for the Pro models, like Video Boost for enhancing low-light video. But it still packs plenty of AI tools—such as Reimagine, Screenshots, and Pixel Studio. While these

features show promise, they feel a bit disjointed. Google's AI capabilities are evolving, but they aren't yet the seamless experience they aspire to be. Google promises seven years of OS updates for the Pixel 9.

The Pixel 9 delivers exactly what many in the Android ecosystem have been waiting for: a straightforward, well-built phone designed to last. **BT**

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